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E3 Reading – Exam Prep Lesson 5: Letters and emails, two linked texts – Lesson plan and answers

Learners finish able to say who wrote a letter or email, who it is for and why, and to answer questions that name one of two linked texts. Task 2 of the paper often pairs a message with its reply.

Materials: Handouts 5A, 5B and 5C, one per learner. The six strips from 5A section B cut up, one set per pair.

Activity 1: The parts of a letter (25 minutes, teacher-led)

1. Draw a large empty letter on the board with six boxes down the page. Ask what goes in a letter or email. Fill the boxes with the class: *greeting; why I am writing; details; what I want; closing line; name*.
2. Ask who learners write to in English. Collect on the board in two columns: people they know (friends, classmates) and people they do not know (council, landlord, doctor, college office).
3. Teach formal and informal with pairs of phrases. Say “Hi Sam” and “Dear Mr Khan”. Ask which is for a friend. Do two more pairs orally.
4. Hand out 5A. Learners match the informal and formal phrases in section A, alone, then check in pairs.
5. Feedback. Teach the closing rule in one line: *Dear Sir or Madam* ends with *Yours faithfully*; *Dear* plus a name ends with *Yours sincerely*. Exam texts follow this rule, so it tells the reader whether the writer knows the name.

Activity 2: Who, to whom, why (25 minutes)

1. Hand out 5B. Before reading, learners look only at the top and bottom of each text for 30 seconds. Ask: Who wrote Text A? Who wrote Text B? Which came first?
2. Learners read both texts silently.
3. Pairs complete the grid on 5C, section A: writer, reader, reason for writing, what the writer wants or offers.
4. Feedback on the board. Ask how they know Samira did not know the name of the person she was writing to. Answer: *Dear Sir or Madam*.
5. Ask whether Text B answers everything in Text A. Learners tick what Samira asked for and find the answer in Text B: an engineer (yes, Thursday), a quick visit (three days later), a reply to her calls (an apology).

Activity 3: Exam questions on two texts (30 minutes)

1. Tell learners that with two texts, each question says which text to read. Have them highlight *Text A* or *Text B* in every question on 5C, section B, before they answer anything.
2. Learners answer alone in 15 minutes.
3. Pairs compare and point to the proof.
4. Class feedback. After question 5, ask why Thursday morning suits Samira. The answer needs both texts: she is at home every morning, and the visit is between 9 and 11. Tell learners the exam does not need this, but it is good reading.
5. For question 9, write the three words in a column and compare letter by letter with *engineer*.

Activity 4: Build the reply (20 minutes)

1. Give each pair the six strips from 5A, section B. They are Samira’s reply to Daniel, mixed up.
2. Pairs put the strips in order and decide which box from Activity 1 each strip belongs to.
3. Check on the board. Ask why she writes *Dear Mr Okoro* and *Yours sincerely* this time.
4. Pairs read the three messages aloud in order, as a conversation.

Activity 5: Read a real one (20 minutes)

1. Ask learners to take out any letter, text or email in English that they have on their phone or in their bag from the college, a doctor or the council. Learners without one share with a partner. Remind them to choose something they are happy to show.
2. Each learner finds four things and tells their partner: who wrote it, who it is for, why, and what they must do.
3. Hear four or five examples. Board any useful phrases that come up, such as *appointment, please confirm, do not reply*.
4. Close: learners tell their partner the two closings and when each is used.

Answer key, Lesson 5

- **5A Section A:** 1 C, 2 E, 3 F, 4 A, 5 B, 6 D.
- **5A Section B order:** Dear Mr Okoro, / Thank you for your reply. / Thursday morning is fine for me. / I will collect the heaters from your office tomorrow. / Yours sincerely, / Samira Haddad.
- **5C Section A:** Text A: Samira Haddad; the repairs team; her heating is broken; an engineer quickly. Text B: Daniel Okoro; Samira; to reply and say sorry; an engineer on Thursday and two heaters to borrow.
- **5C Section B:** 1 B. 2 In the afternoon (she is at college). 3 False. 4 C. 5 A. 6 The email. 7 B. 8 He books an engineer; he lends her two heaters. 9 evening.